Reconciling conflicting evidence

Prototype for review; outside runtime discovery.

The aim is to produce a better account of the disagreement. Sometimes one claim is wrong; sometimes the sources answer different questions; sometimes the available evidence cannot decide. Treat all three as legitimate outcomes.

Recover the actual claims

Read the relevant source passages or tool results rather than relying on a summary of the dispute. Preserve qualifiers, corrections, and the question each source was answering. For a transcript, retain available locators and distinguish the speaker's claim from commentary inferred by the analyst. Do not reconstruct an unseen board from references such as “this spot.”

Restate the disagreement precisely. Separate a claim about mechanics from a claim about observed performance, a recommendation, or a personal preference. An expert recommending an item in a particular spot and a dataset showing a different overall leader may not contradict each other.

Locate the difference

Check the dimensions that could make both claims true: source revision, patch, holder, star level, composition, acquisition conditions, objective, and whether the claim concerns a decision or an achieved state. Follow only differences relevant to this dispute; do not turn reconciliation into a fixed checklist of every possible confounder.

Assess what each source can establish. Explicit rule text bears on mechanics; an account of play can supply context and a proposed rationale; aggregate results describe a defined population. Expertise does not substitute for missing conditions, and a large sample does not make an irrelevant comparison decisive. Several sources repeating the same original claim are not independent support.

Pursue a discriminating check

Identify the observation that would separate the competing explanations. This might be an exact effect restriction, an earlier correction in the transcript, or a comparison within the population the recommendation actually describes.

Use available tools or supplied sources to make that check. Do not silently replace an unavailable condition with a convenient final-board proxy. Narrowing the sample can clarify a claim, but can also remove support or condition on an outcome of the decision itself. Report that tradeoff where it matters.

If no available evidence can distinguish the accounts, state the specific missing fact. Do not resolve disagreement by averaging recommendations, counting sources, or choosing the more confident wording.

Produce a reconciled account

Explain what the sources agree on, where the apparent conflict came from, and what remains disputed. Retain attribution and source locators where available. If one claim is superseded or unsupported, show the evidence for that judgment. If both apply under different conditions, make those conditions usable.

End with the implication for the user's question and the uncertainty that could change it. Stop once the disagreement is resolved or its remaining boundary is clear. A useful result may be a narrower claim rather than a winning source.